Nvidia investigates its CEO

Nvidia's CEO admitted an affair. Now the company's board is investigating, and Congress wants answers about a possible national-security problem.

Level 2 · B1 · 262 words · 11.9 words per sentence · 20 glossed

Jensen Huang, the CEO of Nvidia, has admitted that he had an affair. On Sunday, November 8, he wrote a letter to Nvidia's employees. He said he was unfaithful to his wife, and he said he was sorry to her and to their children.

The story is not only personal. On October 29, The New York Times reported that US officials had been looking into Huang's close relationship with a woman named Alice Huang for more than a year. They are not related. News reports link her to Megaspeed, a company in Singapore that became one of Nvidia's biggest customers. It bought about $4.8 billion in equipment.

Reports say US officials suspect that she was gathering information for China. There is no public proof of this, and no charges have been reported. China says the claims are false, and Megaspeed says it did nothing wrong. There is also no public evidence that Huang knew about any spying.

Nvidia's board has started an independent investigation with outside lawyers. The board says it has no reason to believe that company secrets or national security were put at risk. Huang will stay as CEO.

President Trump called Huang an honorable person. Three Republican chairmen in the House asked Huang to appear before them on November 18, and Senator Elizabeth Warren, a Democrat, also asked for answers. On Monday, Nvidia's shares fell by more than 4 percent.

Why does it matter? The United States does not allow some chip sales to China, and Huang has lobbied for more sales. Nvidia reports its quarterly results on November 17.

GLOSSARY

CEO	diretor-executivo
Nvidia	empresa americana que faz chips para inteligência artificial
admitted	admitiu
affair	relação amorosa fora do casamento
unfaithful	infiel
looking into	investigando, examinando
suspect	suspeitam
gathering information	reunindo informações
proof	prova
charges	acusações formais na Justiça
evidence	evidências, provas
spying	espionagem
board	conselho de administração
investigation	investigação
lawyers	advogados
honorable	honrado
chairmen	presidentes de comissão
appear before them	comparecer diante deles
shares	ações
lobbied	feito pressão política

KEY DATES

Oct 29	The New York Times reports on Huang's close relationship with a woman linked to Megaspeed.
Nov 5	Three Republican committee chairmen in the House ask Huang to appear before Congress.
Nov 8	Huang admits the affair in a letter to employees. The board opens an investigation.
Nov 9	Nvidia shares fall more than 4%.
Nov 17	Nvidia reports its quarterly results. SCHEDULED
Nov 18	The date Congress asked Huang to appear. REQUESTED

Sources: Al Jazeera, SiliconANGLE, Saudi Gazette, International Business Times UK. Dates in 2026.

What we know, and what we do not

Two stories run together here: a private one and a national-security one.
This table keeps them apart.

	CONFIRMED	NOT PROVEN, OR NOT KNOWN YET
HUANG	He admitted the affair in a letter to employees on November 8 and apologized.	Whether he knew about any spying. No public evidence shows that he did.
THE WOMAN	Alice Huang is not related to Jensen Huang. Reports link her to Megaspeed.	US officials reportedly suspect that she gathered information for China. No charges have been reported, and China calls the claim groundless.
MEGASPEED	A company based in Singapore. It bought about $4.8 billion in equipment from Nvidia. Singapore says its inquiries into the company continue.	Whether it broke export rules. Megaspeed denies any wrongdoing.
NVIDIA	The board opened an independent investigation. It says it has no reason to believe that secrets were compromised. Huang stays as CEO.	What the investigation will find. No results have been reported.
CONGRESS	Three Republican committee chairmen asked Huang to appear on November 18. Senator Elizabeth Warren, a Democrat, also wants answers.	Whether he will attend, and what he will say.
THE MARKET	Nvidia shares fell more than 4% on November 9, a loss of about $190 billion in value.	How investors will react to the company's results on November 17.

Sources: Al Jazeera, SiliconANGLE, International Business Times UK, Saudi Gazette. Situation on November 12, 2026.

WORDS IN THIS TABLE AND IN THE KEY DATES

appear before Congress comparecer perante o Congresso
groundless sem fundamento
inquiries investigações oficiais
export rules regras que limitam a venda de tecnologia a outros países
wrongdoing conduta ilegal ou errada
compromised postos em risco

AFTER READING

1. What did Jensen Huang admit, and what did the Nvidia board decide to do?
2. Why is this story about more than a private matter?
3. What has not been proven so far?

TALK ABOUT IT

4. When does a leader's private life become a business problem? Give an example.
5. Huang wrote a letter to his employees to apologize. What makes an apology believable?
6. Some things in the news reports are not proven yet. How do you decide what to believe?
7. Should a country limit the sale of advanced technology to other countries? Why or why not?

PRACTICE

SOURCES

Al Jazeera, US chipmaker Nvidia investigates CEO Jensen Huang over affair

SiliconANGLE, Despite spying scandal, Trump stands by Nvidia boss Jensen Huang

International Business Times UK, Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang Admits Affair as Board Investigates Whether He Was Targeted by Chinese Intelligence

Saudi Gazette, Nvidia chief Jensen Huang admits affair after tech giant opens probe into spy claims

HotHardware, NVIDIA's Jensen Huang Admits Affair As Board Probes China Spy Claims